financed and sponsored by the ISI of Pakistan and some Republican leaders from the US.

I asked Raman whether he had made efforts to ascertain the real reason behind the sudden spurt in pro-Khalistan activities in Punjab and abroad only after the Congress came to power in January 1980. As he had nothing to say, I pointedly told him that the real reason was a conscious decision taken by some senior Congress leaders, soon after Indira Gandhi returned to power in January 1980, to win the next elections (due before January 1985) by first creating and then solving the Khalistan issue through the use of Bhindranwale. I also suggested to him that since the Congress was not in power then (V.P. Singh had become the prime minister on 2 December 1989), he should revise his white paper, thereby exposing the true nature of the conspiracy.

I concluded by saying that the situation that had been created would be taken advantage of by Pakistan and some Western countries for a long time to come. When Raman asked me how, I told him that the ISI would continue to bolster the pro-Khalistan movement using every possible means to avenge its loss of East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) in December 1971. Some of the Western countries would use it as an instrument to further their respective geopolitical, commercial and economic interests in their dealings with India.

Jasjit Singh fully agreed with my views. There was no intervention from the audience and the meeting ended soon after, with the white paper being consigned to the vaults of the Department for future reference. It is obvious that my dissenting view had not been placed in the concerned folder as it would have reflected poorly on the credibility of the Department. Is there not a need for revision of this white paper or the Central government's white paper on Punjab released in July 1984 or, for that matter, similar white papers produced by other ministries or departments? It is for the authorities concerned to consider. The author has done his part of the job by writing this book.

